GOAD — MiniLAB Walkthrough

systemweakness.com/goad-minilab-walkthrough-c4038e70bde7

serkanbenol May 10, 2026

System Weakness is a publication that specialises in publishing upcoming writers in cybersecurity and ethical hacking space. Our security experts write to make the cyber universe more secure, one vulnerability at a time.

GOAD (Game of Active Directory) is a fantastic lab for practicing AD pentest techniques. In this post, I'll walk through how I fully compromised the MiniLAB environment — including the things that *didn't* work along the way, because that's how pentesting actually goes in real life.

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The Garden of earthly delights by Hieronymus Bosch

Our targets : 172.16.20.30–172.16.20.31I start with the very basic nmap scan :

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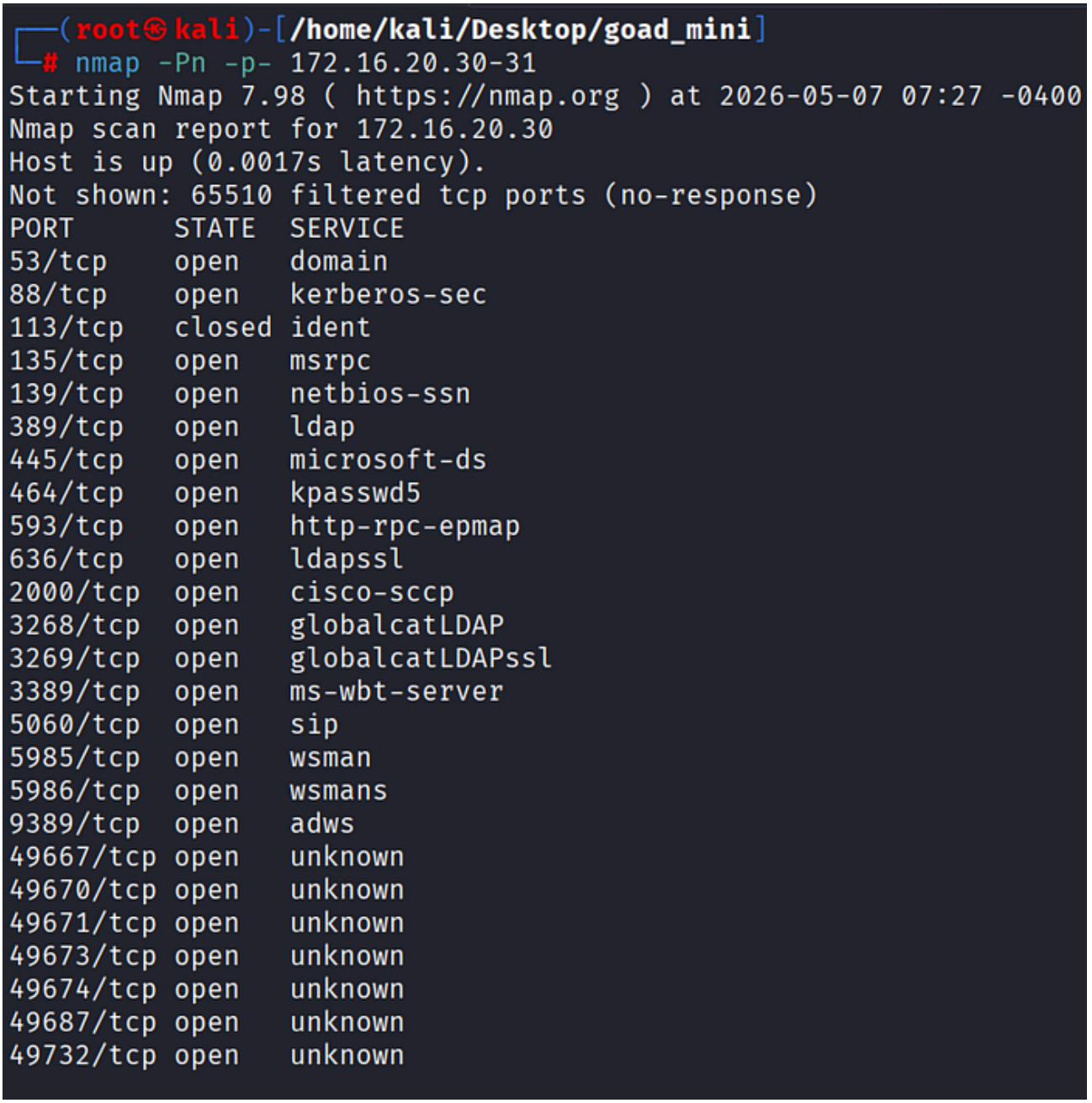

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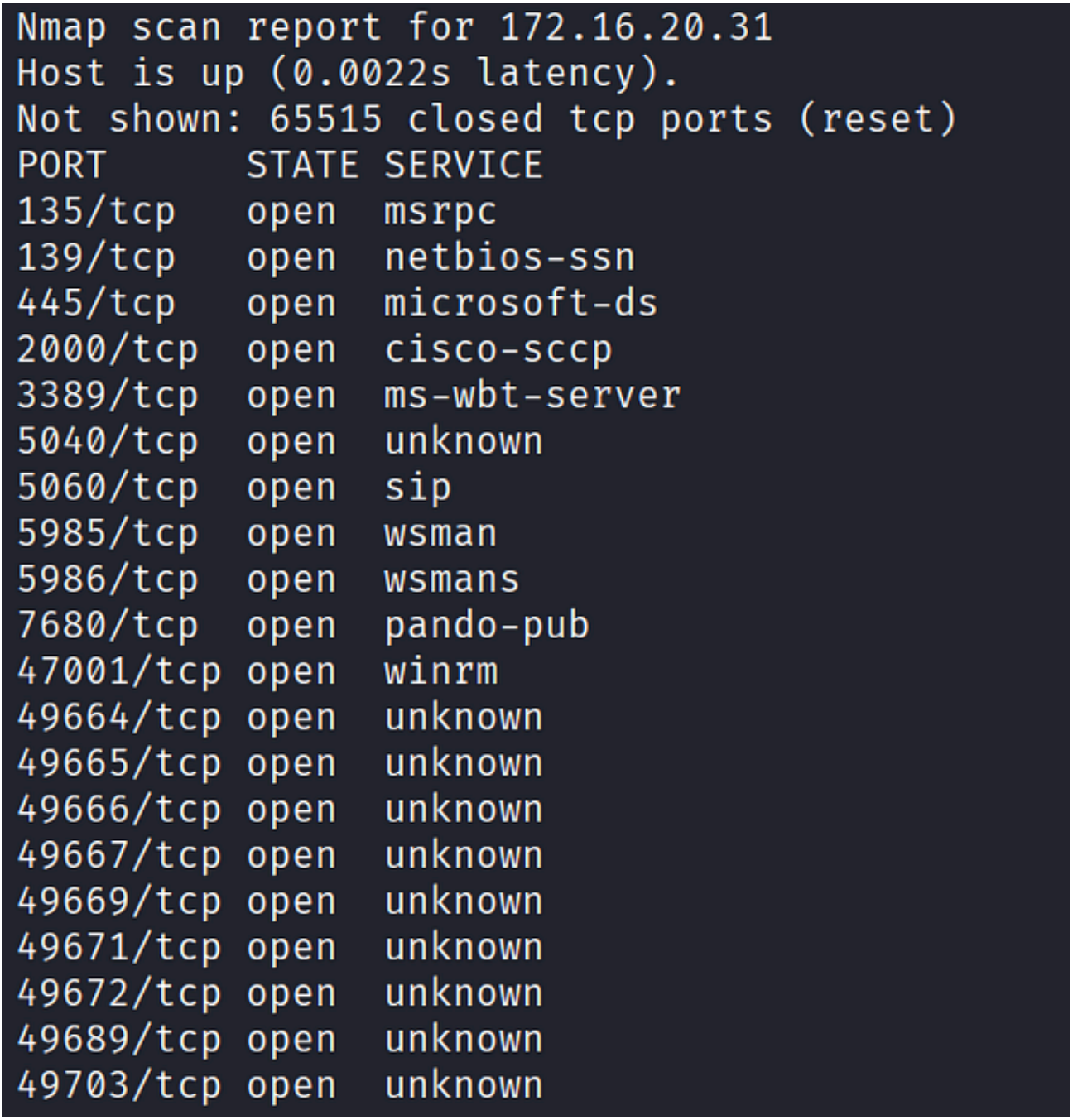

The scan confirmed both hosts as Windows systems. The DC (`172.16.20.30`) exposed the expected Active Directory service stack: **Kerberos (88)**, **LDAP (389/636)**, **SMB (445)**, **DNS (53)**, **RPC (135)**, and **WinRM (5985)**.

After I couple of trial on enumeration, I run`enum4linux-ng` against the DC to test for anonymous/null session access

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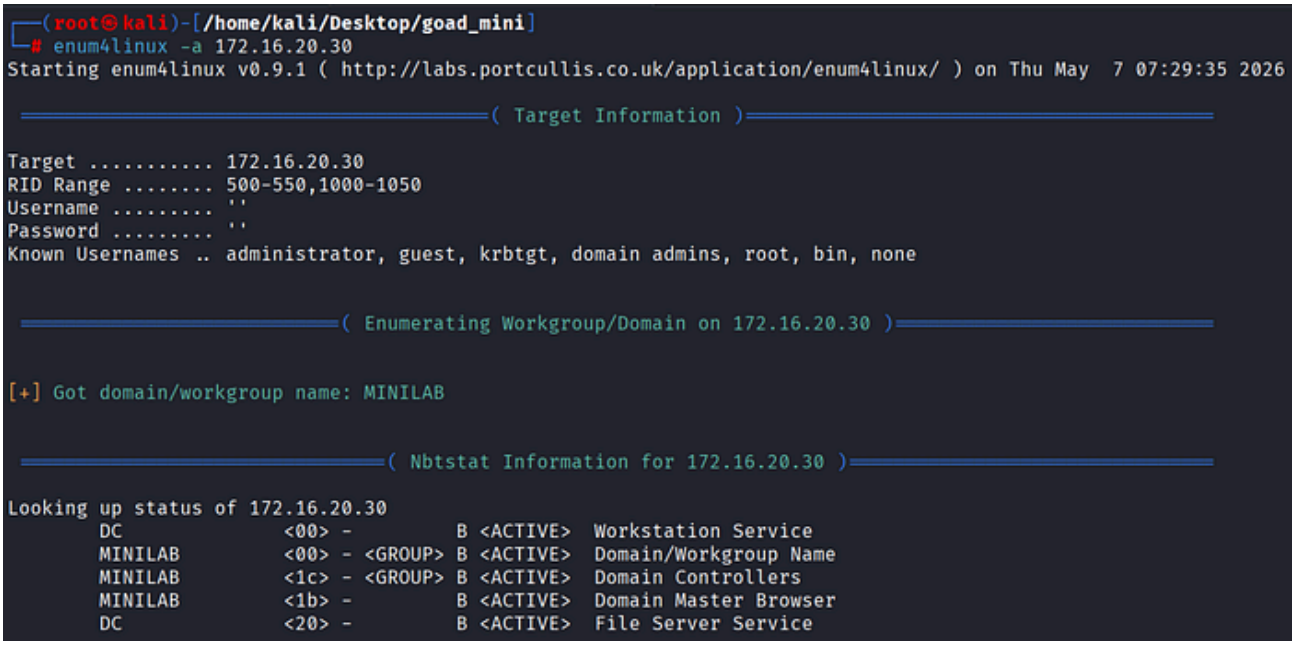

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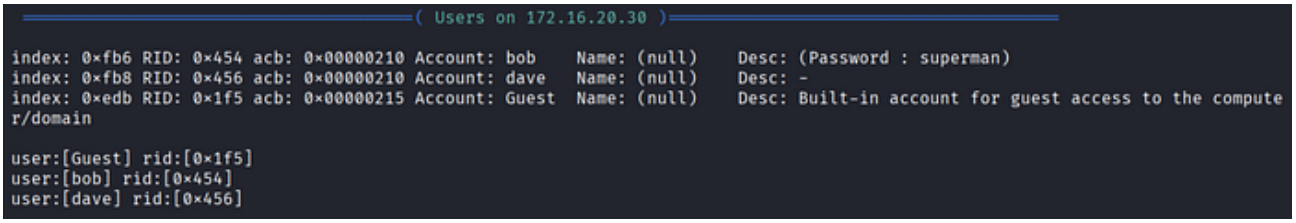

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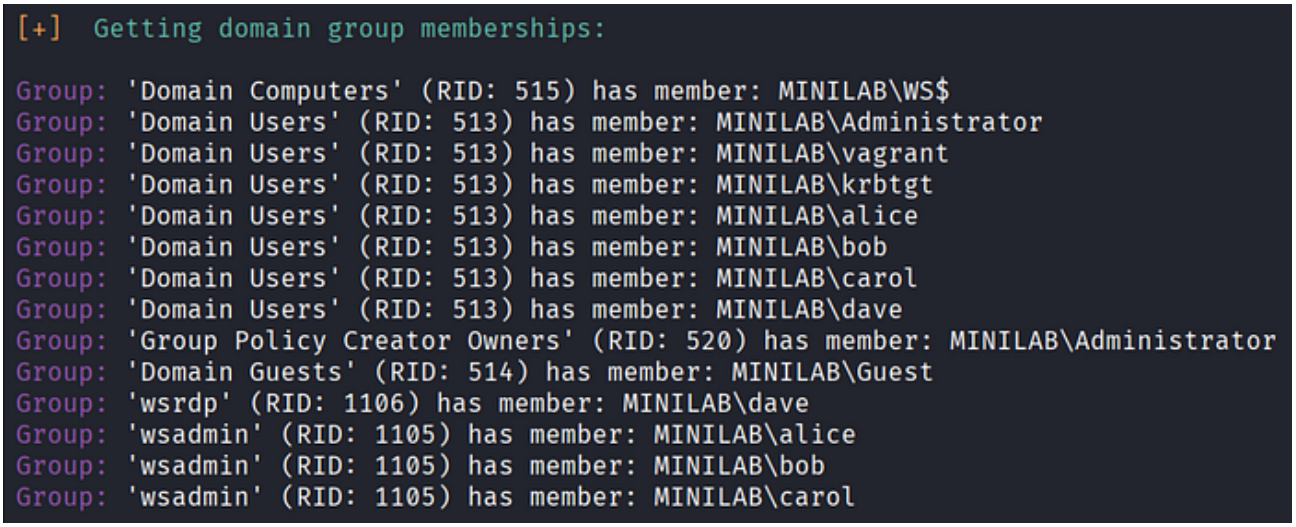

RID cycling listed the domain users: `Administrator`, `krbtgt`, `vagrant`, `alice`, `bob`, `carol`, `dave`. But the real prize was in the **description** field of the user objects — `bob`'s description had a **cleartext password** left in it.

The things I tried but not wasn't very useful :+ asreproasting+ kerberoasting+ pivoting to the host 172.16.20.31 via psexec+ enumerating the shares..The golden shot was extracting the LSA secrets with netexec:

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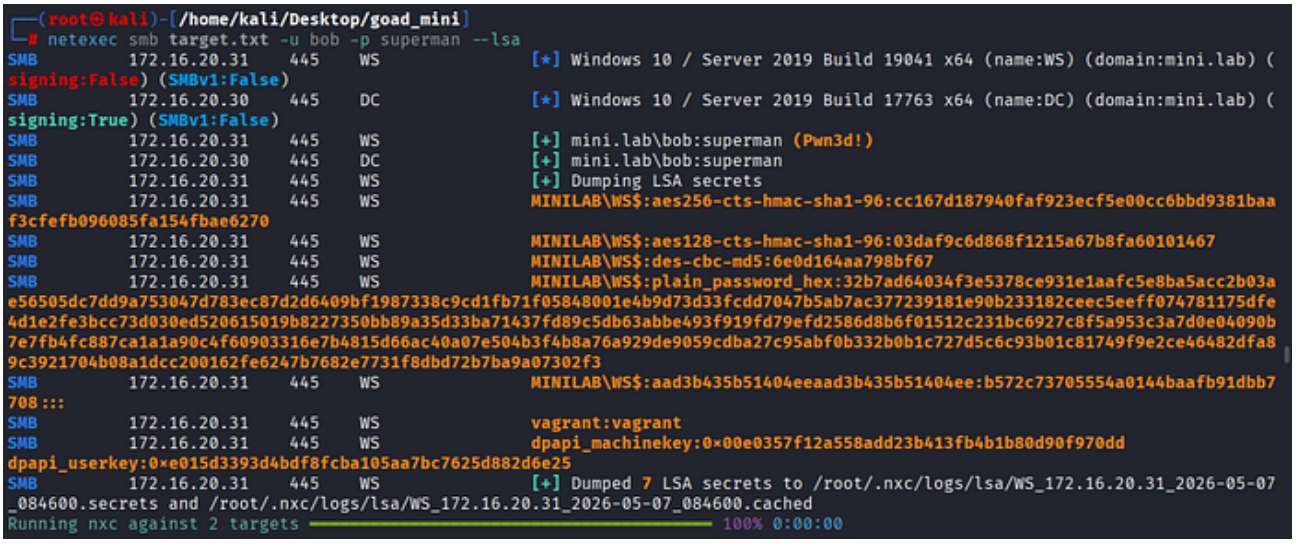

The output had a goldmine: **`vagrant`**'s cleartext password. Cool!I tried dumping the local hashes on the domain controller:

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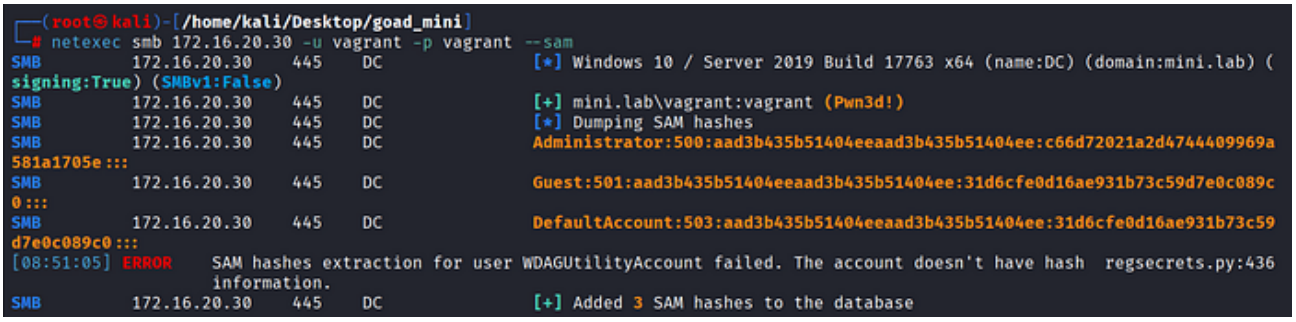

Great! We have NT hash of the Administrator which lets us Pass-the-Hash attack :

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I have now shell on DC, which is a full compromise of the domain!

Summary`description field exposure (bob's password)`

↓

```
bob → local admin on 172.16.20.31
↓
LSA Secrets dump → vagrant's cleartext password
↓
vagrant → local admin on the DC
↓
SAM dump → Administrator NT hash
↓
Pass-the-Hash → Domain Admin
```

Thanks for reading!

Sources :https://www.hackingarticles.in/credential-dumping-with-netexec-nxc/
https://juggernaut-sec.com/pass-the-hash-attacks/